

Ken Smart

Experienced Engineer and Leader working to return to my roots in technology. Seeking experienced IC positions in backend systems or production availability/reliability.

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EXPERIENCE

Equinix, Redwood City, CA — Director, Software Architecture and Engineering

March 2023 - January 2024

Hired during a time of transformation for the company. New leadership from the Director level and up was brought in to transform the Digital Services business unit after acquisition of Packet which was rebranded as Equinix Metal. Teams that directly reported to me have included Kubernetes CI/CD team, Infrastructure Security, Containerized Network Functions (CNF), and Virtualized Network Functions (VNF). Established both the CNF and VNF team within the first 3 months of onboarding and grew the teams to deliver core transformational company deliverables.

Salesforce, San Francisco, CA — Director, Software Engineering

May 2017 - March 2023

Founding manager of the Salesforce Edge, a performance driven caching layer that operates similar to a CDN inside the Salesforce network. Designed the entire system from ground up including a globally distributed DNS system, BGP ECMP load balancer, control plane API, and dataplane utilizing Nginx. Starting with a team of 4 engineers I worked to grow the organization to over 30 engineers across multiple teams each with a specific deliverable for the Edge. Drove empowerment of the engineers to feel ownership over their deliverables to further drive them forward with the passion that comes from that responsibility.

Salesforce, San Francisco, CA — Lead Systems Engineer

June 2013 - May 2017

Member of the infrastructure core team, worked toward the goal of delivering a network and system platform for the core business units to use. Worked day to day to automate the core operations stack for Salesforce Data Centers worldwide. This included DHCP, DNS, IPAM, NTP, Directory Services, External Proxy, and many others. In addition to my engineering role, I served in a leadership position as the team's scrum master.

Limelight Networks, Tempe, AZ — Systems Engineer

June 2008 - June 2013

DevOps team member within the overall CDN Architecture organization, working to design and develop systems for service automation and inventory management. This included systems for DHCP, PXE, DNS, hardware inventory, and utilization data. Worked in an Agile development environment specializing in Perl and Python development. Acquired in depth knowledge about all systems used to perform content delivery and deploy systems, network gear, and other devices.

EDUCATION

Western Governors University, Salt Lake City, UT

- **Bachelor of Science, Information Technology Management**
Mar 2017 - June 2020
- **Master of Science, Cybersecurity & Information Assurance**
Mar 2024 - In Progress (est Mar 2025)

PROJECTS

Equinix VM Platform — 2023

Built internal Virtualization platform using Kubernetes to orchestrate VMs

Salesforce Edge — 2017-2023

Built internal Content Delivery Network (CDN)

System Automation — 2014-2017

Converted legacy bare metal build systems to orchestrated cloud infrastructure

FedRamp Certification — 2013-2014

Built and documented overall system design for US Government Certification

Cornerstone — 2010-2013

Designed and implemented a network inventory system for system automation. 20k+ network assets managed.

KEY SKILLS

Internet scale distributed system design

Internet Core Infrastructure: DNS, TCP/IP, HTTP, etc.

CI/CD: Kubernetes, Argo, Atlas, Git, etc.

AWARDS

Time Based CDN Traffic Allocation —
Lead Inventor United States Patent #: 8775564

LANGUAGES

Go Lang, Python, Ruby, PHP, Perl

